

Gathering Customer Feedback

An EWOR Checklist

This guide helps you design and run effective customer feedback interviews — from brainstorming the right questions to turning raw answers into actionable insights.

It follows a simple, structured process that moves from free-form idea collection to clear interview guides, and finally to clustering and analysing feedback.

Whether you're validating a product, uncovering user pain points, or refining features, this resource will help your team ask better questions, listen deeply, and make sense of what you hear.

Step 1

Prepare Your Questions

Before conducting interviews, take time to plan the right questions. This step is about exploring what you want to learn and shaping it into a conversation that flows. Work with your team to brainstorm, group, and refine questions that will surface meaningful insights.

- **Start with a free-form brainstorm**
Gather your team and write down any and all potential questions—don't filter yet. Think broadly: routines, goals, challenges, preferences, recent decisions, and so on.
- **Review and refine the questions**
Compare all the questions, keeping the useful ones and removing the rest.
- **Group questions into blocks**
Organise related questions into themed buckets that flow naturally in conversation.
- **Turn it into a structured document**
Transfer the blocks into a clean questionnaire format. (See the attached sample from a banking project for inspiration.)
- **Do a final review**
Read through the questionnaire—this often reveals a few missing or inspired questions.
- **Create stakeholder-specific versions**
Tailor different versions of the questionnaire for different groups (e.g. users, buyers, partners), depending on what's relevant to each.

Questions to Ask

Regardless of who your stakeholders are—users, buyers, partners, or internal teams—it's important to ask a variety of questions that explore different dimensions of their experience.

Consider questions that touch on:

- Context and how they see their role fitting to your product or service.
- Their relationship to your product or service.
- The tasks they perform and how they get them done.
- How they perceive and access your offerings.
- Their expectations around service and self-service.
- How they search for and manage information.

Below are a few examples of questions your team might brainstorm during your session. However, you might also find that better, more relevant questions emerge once you consider your specific audience, context, and goals.

Context & Role

- Can you walk me through a typical day when you use [this type of product/service]?
- What is your main goal for using this product or service?
- What are some responsibilities you handle regularly?
- What's something you do often that most people might overlook?
- Are there any small tasks or habits you've developed to make things easier?

Goals and Needs

- What would "success" look like for you with a tool like this?
- What outcomes are you really hoping to achieve?
- Are there gaps in your current setup?
- What do you wish worked better?
- Is there anything you dread doing in this process?

Integration & Technical Depth

- What tools does this need to connect with?
- How do you currently move data between systems?
- What would prevent you from adopting another tool?
- Do you have API requirements or technical constraints?

Value Metrics Over Features

- What metric would this need to move for you to consider it successful?
- How much time/money does this problem currently cost you?
- What's the consequence of not solving this?

Tasks and Workarounds

- What tasks are you trying to accomplish when using a product like ours?
- How do you currently handle those tasks?
- Can you walk me through a recent time you solved [problem] on your own?
- What tools or systems do you rely on?
- What's most frustrating about how you do this today?

B2B Buying Process Questions

- Who else needs to approve or use this tool?
- What's your typical evaluation timeline for new software?
- How do you measure ROI on tools like this?
- What would your legal/IT/security team need to see?
- What's your budget approval process?

AI-Specific Question Categories

- How do you currently evaluate AI tool accuracy/reliability?
- What would make you trust AI-generated outputs in your workflow?
- Do you need to explain AI decisions to stakeholders? How?
- What data privacy or compliance concerns do you have with AI tools?
- How transparent do our AI recommendations need to be?

Relationship to Your Product and Solution

- How did you first hear about our product/service?
- How would you describe your relationship with [our company/product]?
- Is this something you use regularly, occasionally, or only when needed?
- What changed for you after you started using our [product/service]?
- Why did you choose to use our [product/service] over other options?

Product or Service Feedback

- What was your first impression of our product?
- What's working well for you? What's not?
- Was anything confusing or unexpected?
- What do you think is missing?
- Do you prefer self-service or direct support?
- Do you think there is a right way to make or accomplish this offer?

Offerings & Awareness

- Do you feel clear about what we offer?
- Are you personally interested in our new offerings?
- How do you typically learn about new offerings from a company like ours?
- Can you recall a time when you discovered something new and useful?

Information Seeking

- Where do you usually go to find information or solve problems?
- Was there anything that almost stopped you from moving forward with us?
- Can you describe how you've approached researching similar tools?

Step 2

Capturing and Processing Answers

Once the interview begins, your job is to listen, observe, and capture insights as they come. Don't worry about structure now – focus on depth.

Later, transcribing and rewriting answers will help surface meaning and patterns.

- **Take notes freely during the interview**
Use a notepad or document to jot down raw answers as they come – don't worry about format or structure. Focus on capturing language, tone, and standout quotes.
- **(Optional) Record the interview**
If the person agrees, record the conversation so you can revisit it later and avoid missing details.
- **Transcribe key points onto Post-Its**
After the interview, go back through your notes (or recording) and write key points or quotes onto individual Post-Its. This step helps you process and internalise what has been said.
- **Use transcription as reflection**
Writing answers out again—by hand or digitally—deepens your understanding and often reveals insights you missed during the live conversation.
- **Avoid rigid templates**
While you can provide a lined sheet or form, be mindful: people tend to fill it mechanically or feel limited by it. Freeform note-taking usually works better.

Step 3

Step 3 Synthesising Insights

After you've gathered responses, it's time to make sense of them.

Use Post-Its to physically or digitally rearrange ideas, look for patterns, and pull out common themes. This step is where raw feedback becomes valuable insight.

1 Use Post-Its for flexibility and cluster into related groups

Transfer each key point or observation onto individual Post-Its. This allows you to easily rearrange, cluster, and explore your findings. Try combining similar or related themes. Feel free to reorder, reshuffle, duplicate, or split clusters as your understanding evolves.

Pro Tip
Consider a Feedback Capture Grid for Early Sorting

Before clustering begins, you can use a Feedback Capture Grid to help sort and structure observations from testing sessions or user interviews.

Using this grid helps you quickly separate positive feedback from pain points and surface open questions or suggestions. Once you've sorted feedback into the grid, you can transfer the sticky notes into broader thematic clusters across all participants.

Feedback Grid

Note: Ask others for feedback and capture it in a structured way

What was good?	What was not so good? What was missing?
Which questions are still open?	Which ideas for improvement came up?

2 Detach insights from sources

Separate insights from the identity of the interviewee to reduce personal bias and focus purely on the content and patterns.

3 Summarise clusters into observations and insights

We recommend the following set-up for this step:

Observations and Insights

Note: Ask others for feedback and capture it in a structured way

